

Cristi Prodan

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Summary

Senior Software Engineer specializing in backend platforms, distributed systems, and cloud infrastructure. I build reliable production services, own them in operation, and work comfortably across APIs, security, CI/CD, observability, and product delivery.

Experience

Founder, Comerz (Remote, Romania)

Mar 2025 - Current

- Founded and bootstrapped <https://comerz.ro>, a multitenant e-commerce platform that enables entrepreneurs to create and manage online stores.
- Designed and built the MVP end-to-end with Rails and PostgreSQL, covering tenant isolation, storefront management, product/catalog workflows, and production deployment.
- Used AI-assisted development workflows with Codex, Conductor, and Linear to accelerate implementation, product iteration, and delivery.

Senior Software Engineer, Zerofy (Remote, Romania)

Jan 2024 - Feb 2025

- Built backend workflows for the Zerofy mobile application using Google Cloud Functions, Firebase, and Node.js on GCP.
- Implemented serverless, event-driven integrations that connected the product to external vendors and data providers.
- Reverse-engineered undocumented vendor interfaces when official documentation was incomplete or unavailable.
- Improved maintainability through targeted refactors, cleanup, and clearer boundaries around integration code.

Senior Software Engineer, PTC Schweiz (Zürich, Switzerland and Remote, Romania) Oct 2015 - Jan 2024

- Built, owned, and operated Vuforia Cloud microservices in Scala/Akka on AWS for manufacturing-focused augmented reality products.
- Collaborated with Machine Learning engineers to integrate models into production APIs and containerized services, and wrote a data pipeline and workflow orchestration for ML models from scratch.
- Handled distributed systems concerns including scaling, fault tolerance, load balancing, service security, production deployments, and on-call incident response.
- Operated Kubernetes-based services and improved observability with Elasticsearch, Logstash, and Kibana.

- Built CI/CD and infrastructure workflows using GitHub Actions, TeamCity, AWS CloudFormation, and Terraform.
- Delivered customer-facing backend APIs, including search APIs for Vivino and production APIs for ML model integrations.
- Improved reliability with end-to-end REST API tests in Scala and refactors of long-lived services.
- Strengthened security by integrating Veracode and Snyk, applying OWASP practices, and implementing Single Sign-On with Amazon Cognito.
- Built internal deployment/productivity tooling and led initiatives that improved developer productivity across multiple teams.
- Authored OpenAPI v3 documentation and implemented a WebSocket proxy service for real-time remote assistance collaboration.
- Conducted technical interviews and contributed to engineering hiring decisions.

Senior Engineer, Qualcomm (Zürich, Switzerland)

Jan 2014 - Oct 2015

- Expanded AWS cloud services with Scala and Play.
- Automated operations and internal tooling with Python and Bash.
- Ported services to Docker and maintained legacy Ruby on Rails systems.
- Designed and built an internal Ruby DSL for cross-team API testing.
- Participated in scaling infrastructure from a few to hundreds of EC2 instances on AWS (S3, SQS, DynamoDB, Cognito, Autoscaling).

Software Engineer, Kooaba (Zürich, Switzerland)

Feb 2011 - Jan 2014

- Initiated and led the migration from a monolith to Scala microservices, improving scalability and reducing memory usage.
- Built REST APIs and backend services with Ruby on Rails.
- Rewrote and maintained an Android application.
- Optimized MySQL queries and indexes on live production databases with 30m+ rows.

Head of Technology, Alliants (Cluj-Napoca, Romania)

Sep 2008 - Feb 2011

- Hired and led a team of 3 engineers delivering Ruby on Rails applications for customer projects.
- Coordinated on-site delivery with customers in London and translated business requirements into implementation plans.

Skills

- Languages: **Scala**, Ruby, Python, JavaScript, Bash
- Backend and APIs: Akka/Pekko, Rails, Play, Node.js, REST APIs, OpenAPI, OAuth2, JWT, SSO
- Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, CloudFormation, Terraform, Serverless
- Data and Search: MySQL, PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana
- Testing and Tooling: GitHub Actions, TeamCity, Linux

Education

- Master's Degree, Computer Science – Babes-Bolyai University, Cluj-Napoca (2008-2010). Thesis: Recommender Systems using Collaborative Filtering. <https://github.com/christian/Rho-article>
- Bachelor's Degree, Computer Science – Alexandru Ioan Cuza University, Iasi (2005-2008). Thesis: Mobile Recommender System.
- Machine Learning Course – Andrew Ng (2011). Completed before Coursera launched as a public platform.

Languages

English (fluent), Romanian (fluent), German (basic)

Fun projects

- Virtual Private Organ: Long-running hardware/software project building a custom digital pipe organ. Includes woodworking, MIDI electronics, Arduino programming, audio setup, and documentation.